

EEF Meeting Minutes, Thursday March 4, 2021

Erlang Ecosystem Foundation, Minutes of a Regular Meeting of the Board of Directors Meeting #44, March 4, 2021

A regular meeting of the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation was held over group conference call (Zoom). The meeting began at 16:04 UTC.

Attendance

The following members of the board of directors were present (11/11): Richard Carlsson, Francesco Cesarini, Benoît Chesneau, Maxim Fedorov, Frédéric Trottier-Hébert, Kenneth Lundin, Peer Stritzinger, Sebastian Strollo, José Valim, Miriam Pena Villanueva, and Alistair Woodman.

Bryan Paxton was also present

Agenda Items

1. Vote of the minutes of the previous meeting.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the minutes as presented as representing a true and accurate record of the board meeting #43 held on Feb 18, 2020. Unanimously approved.

2. Intermediate actions:

1. The Machine Learning Working Group was approved by offline unanimous consent (over email). See attached charter.
 2. The education working group stipend request for \$2500 was approved by offline unanimous consent (over email). See attached request. (Francesco noted that he would normally abstain from the vote, given conflict of interest - but had approved for the process to receive unanimous consent).
 3. The Infrastructure WG has prepared for onboarding of Nayra
3. Financial update: We have approximately \$142K in the bank, we have outstanding invoices to: Nayra (\$1K), Approved Stipends (\$27K), Education WG stipends \$2.5K. Invoices to sponsors will go out next week (we have 5 sponsors ready to be invoiced). Membership numbers have gone up since last report: Annual Supporting members: 108 (+8), Lifetime Supporting members: 11 (unchanged), Basic members: 593 (+45)

4. Board vote. Blog post is up, twitter, and newsletter email has been sent out. Currently have three candidates (of the existing board members up for re-election only Maxim has sent in their profile so far. Peer, Benoit, and Miriam haven't yet sent in their profiles but plan to run for re-election.) Everything is running on schedule so far.
5. Bryan has given notice that he will not continue his contract for the infrastructure work he has been doing so far. A big thank you to Bryan for what he has achieved, it has made a big difference having someone there with actual hours to spend on getting things done. There is a concern that we do not have a replacement and no one that has the time to do the (time consuming) tasks of not only implementation work but also "cat herding". The board asks the infrastructure working group to create a contingency plan for the future.
6. Sponsorship Working Group update: the WG had a meeting last Thursday (Feb 25), the list of current sponsor has been divided up among the members for reaching out. Some sponsors have already accepted staying on as sponsors for 2021.
7. Any other business
 1. Fred noted that given the current candidates to the board we may end up with board members being employees of other board members, and would we need some kind of code of conduct for these situations? Some non-profits have a conflict of interest policy that also includes periodic reporting, so far we have done this on a per vote basis (i.e. typically a board member with conflicting interest will abstain from voting in the matter). We already have a conflict of interest policy (section 5.13 and 5.14 in our bylaws). Fred will look into integrating the 5.14 information in the board candidate bio.
 2. Benoit have applied for Google Summer of Code 2021 (we will know if we are approved as an organization on March 10), if you have suggestions for projects reach out.
 3. Francesco: Code BEAM V Americas is next week (March 10-11). Peer is handling keynote. Are there any working groups that want to lead a BoF session? Should we advertise and/or open up the keynote for streaming to non-conference goers? Point of contact: Barbara at ESL - Peer and Alistair to follow up.
8. Alistair declared the meeting adjourned at 16:52 UTC.

Dated March 4, 2021

Secretary of the meeting: _____ Sebastian Strollo

Attachments:

1. Education Working group stipend proposal, as submitted by Miriam on March 2, 2021 (2 pages)
2. Machine Learning Working Group charter, as submitted by José on February 24, 2021 (2 pages)

Education Working Group Stipend Proposal

Hi Board,

Hope you are all doing well. I have this proposal that has been approved by the Education working group.

I would like for you to **VOTE and approve it** ahead of the next meeting as one of these conferences is just one week away and I would like to notify the recipients as soon as possible.

With this I request:

- **150 tickets for 2500\$ (less than 17\$ per ticket)**
 - 60 tickets for Code Beam V America.
 - 90 tickets for Code Beam V Europe.
- **to give the freedom to the Education WG to decide how to distribute the tickets.** They will be allocated to universities students, minorities or other individuals who could otherwise not afford to attend.

On Fri, Feb 26, 2021 at 10:29 PM EEF Stipend Submissions <notifications@erlef.org> wrote:

Stipend Proposal

Stipend Type : conference

First name : Miriam

Last Name : Pena

Nick Name : MiriamPena

Email Address : miriampena@gmail.com

Phone Number : 4158678182

Organization Name : EEF Education

Organization Email :

City : San francisco

Region : California

Postal Code : 94111

Country : United States

Twitter : miriampena

Linkedin :

Website :

Bio :

Miriam loves to architect scalable, high performance, high concurrency, and high availability systems. Bonus point if they are written in Erlang/Elixir. She is a Sr Staff Engineer at NextRoll, designing critical parts of their AdServers infrastructure, organizer of the Erlang and Elixir meetup in San Francisco & board member and founder of the EEF.

Purpose

On behalf of the Education Working group I would like to request 2500\$ that we can use to purchase 150 tickets for the next two Code Beam V conferences. We will offer these tickets to students, women and other minorities or people who could otherwise not afford to go to these conferences. The decision of how to distribute these tickets will be delegated to 'external and internal requesters' that will be approved by the members of the Education Working Group. As an example, the Education working group will approve to assign 20 tickets to a University teacher that will distribute the tickets among his students using his/her best judgement. In the past each 'requester from our community' would do a request that would go for approval first to the working group and then to the Board. By doing only one request to the board now we aim to simplify the process for everyone and move more quickly.

Code of Conduct link :

Report : We will invite the recipients to tweet about it, and write their experiences on a blog post but we will not enforce it. We will sync with Marketing to spread the word and celebrate our successes.

Stipend Amount (USD) : 2500

Payment Method : Wire

Beneficiaries : At this moment we expect to allocate - 60 tickets for Code Beam V America. - 90 tickets for Code Beam V Europe. During the last weeks We have identified some recipients that would be in charge of distributing some of these tickets among their students/students of contacts/network. As an example of currently assigned ones: -- 34 for Code Beam V America would be distributed by Lee S Barney, from the Brigham Young University in Idaho -- 2 for Code Beam V America will be distributed by Adolfo Neto, Associate Professor at the Federal University of Technology - Paraná. -- 20 for Code Beam V America will be distributed by Norberto Ortigoza. He plans to distribute the tickets between her female students from LatinoAmerica, students from the "Universidad autónoma of Mexico UNAM" and other people that attend the meetups in Mexico. The rest of the tickets are currently unassigned.

machine learning wg.md

Machine Learning Working Group

To develop the ecosystem on all aspects in the context of Machine Learning, from native compilation to high-level abstractions and auxiliary projects.

Long-term objectives

- Integrate with state-of-the-art tools for native numerical compilation. The goal is to target different accelerators (CPU/GPU) and with different modes (AOT/JIT)
- Provide high-level abstractions for different disciplines of machine learning, such as neural networks, supervised learning, clustering, etc
- Develop auxiliary projects that are essential to numerical computing and machine learning efforts, such as interactive tools, plotting libraries, etc

Benefits to the community

- Our goal is to enable the Erlang Ecosystem to be used for Machine Learning and other numerical computing tasks. We believe functional programming can be a good fit for numerical computing, especially as we move to higher-level abstractions.
- The Machine Learning WG also plans to collaborate with other Working Groups on many efforts. For example, Build and Packaging can help us discuss how to ship precompiled libraries. The Machine Learning and Embedded WG can work together on to provide tooling that runs on the edge. The External Process Communication can assist us to integrate with native tools.

Why does this group require the Foundation

This working group can benefit from the foundation in several ways:

- The foundation can provide us communication tools so the Machine Learning WG becomes the main hub for ML discussions in the ecosystem

- The Foundation can facilitate collaboration with interested WGs and relevant efforts happening in the ecosystem
- The Foundation can fund some of the tasks outlined in our long-term deliverables

Initial list of volunteers

- José Valim (chair)
- Sean Moriarity (chair)
- Jason Goldberger
- Jonatan Kłosko
- Stas Versilov
- Peer Stritzinger